



Sony PS4: Know it all

Tantalizing details of Sony's next-gen gaming console were announced late last month. Take a look: <http://dgit.in/WYoNEp>

Tech giants' science award

The annual Breakthrough Prize in Life Sciences Foundation splits a \$33 million booty among 11 people, eclipsing the Nobel Prize. <http://dgit.in/YcWe3U>

Gigabyte GA Z77X-UP7

Great-looking board with a feature-set which will appeal to enthusiasts

Very few motherboards make you really admire their design, colours and build. Gigabyte GA-Z77X-UP7 is one such board. The heat sinks are wonderfully designed with the sturdy heat pipe connecting them. The black-coloured body, five PCIe slots for a four-way GPU setup, eight SATA ports, two eight-pin power connectors, a 32+3+2 phase power and extra buttons for direct overclocking from the board itself put it right against the ASUS ROG series' enthusiast boards.

The brand new feature on this Gigabyte board is the presence of dedicated overclocking buttons just beside the DIMM slots on the top edge. The top two buttons are meant to increase or decrease the multi-



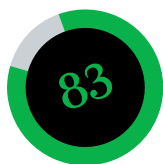
Price
₹26,550

plier and the bottom two are meant to adjust the base clock (BCLK) in 0.1MHz steps. This allows you to overclock your CPU from the Windows environment itself. Just behind the SATA connectors, you have an mSATA port to add in an additional SSD for SSD caching. Of course it also sports the UEFI BIOS and has extra buttons for switching BIOSes, switching to LN2 cooling, and so on. In short, it has everything going for it as far as an enthusiast board goes.

We tested the board using an Intel Core i7-3770K, AMD HD 6850, 2x4GB Kingston DDR3 RAM at 1333MHz. The scores were similar to the ones got on other Z77 boards and there were no unwanted surprises. Overclocking the board was quite easy whether from the BIOS, from the Easy Tune 6 utility or the on-board Gear buttons. We overclocked the Core i7-3770K to 4.6GHz on a stock Intel cooler, thereby getting a 25 per cent gain in Cinebench R11.5 scores. The board is definitely capable of much more.

It also has a PCIe x1 card housing the WiFi and Bluetooth adapter. The pricing of ₹26,550 ensures that it is targeting a niche enthusiast client base.

Nimish Sawant



Features	85
Overclocking.....	85
Build Quality	85
Value for money	75

Specifications

Socket: LGA 1155; **Expansion slots:** 5x PCIe x16, 2x PCIe x1; **USB:** 10 x USB 3.0 + 4 x USB 2.0; **Display Interface:** HDMI, DVI, D-Sub, Display Port

Contact

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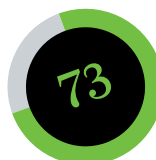
Seagate Barracuda XT 2TB

Decent performer at slightly higher price point



Price
₹12,000

Just like the Barracuda XT 3TB we saw last month, the Barracuda XT 2TB sports a 7200 RPM drive with a 64 MB of cache. The Barracuda XT 2TB gave comparatively slower speeds than the WD Black 2 TB drive and is much slower than the Seagate XT 3TB. Sequential Read / Write: 132 / 139 MB/s and Assorted Read / Write: 128 / 95 MB/s. It was slower in the intra-drive transfer speeds when compared with the WD 2TB. Its cost per GB comes to ₹6.44 which is slightly higher than that offered by the XT 3TB. If you can, spend the ₹2,000 extra and get the XT 3TB drive.



Features	80
Performance.....	75
Build Quality	NA
Value for money.....	65

Specifications

Unformatted Capacity: 1863.02 GB; **Interface:** SATA 3; **Rotational Speed:** 7200 RPM; **Advanced 4K:** Yes; **Buffer size:** 64 MB

Contact

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3M Natural View screen protector for iPad

Tough to install, but does the job



Price
₹1,800

From the outset, it looks like just any screen protector, but is slightly thicker than most. That will be helpful in protecting the screen against scratches better. The main attraction for buying this is the Stay Clean surface, which is supposed to not allow the smudges that fingerprints tend to make, to stick on. In our experience, this protector does the job better than most screen protectors, but is still not 100 per cent smudge free.

Deploying on the iPad is a fairly tough job though, but worth the pricey tag.



Features	NA
Performance.....	65
Build Quality	70
Value for money.....	60

Specifications

Type: Screen protector
Compatibility: Apple iPad 2 and Apple iPad (3rd and 4th generation)
Scratch resistant; Smudge free

Contact

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